Turning Practice into Research: One-Page Guide

Michelle Angelo-Rocha, Ph.D. · michelleangelorocha@gmail.com

Turning practice into research, on one page

Keep this next to you when you start a new project

1 List your projects

Programs, courses, roles
Who is involved?
What worked or failed?

2 Map your data

Surveys, tests, records
Interviews, focus groups
Field notes, documents

3 Find your questions

Who, how many? (descriptive)
Did it change? (outcome)
How did it feel? (experience)
What lasted? (impact)

4 Methods and ethics

Qual: meanings, experiences
Quant: measure and compare
Mixed: numbers plus story
IRB before you collect

5 Where to share

Peer-reviewed articles
Conference presentations
Reports, briefs, toolkits
Podcasts and dashboards

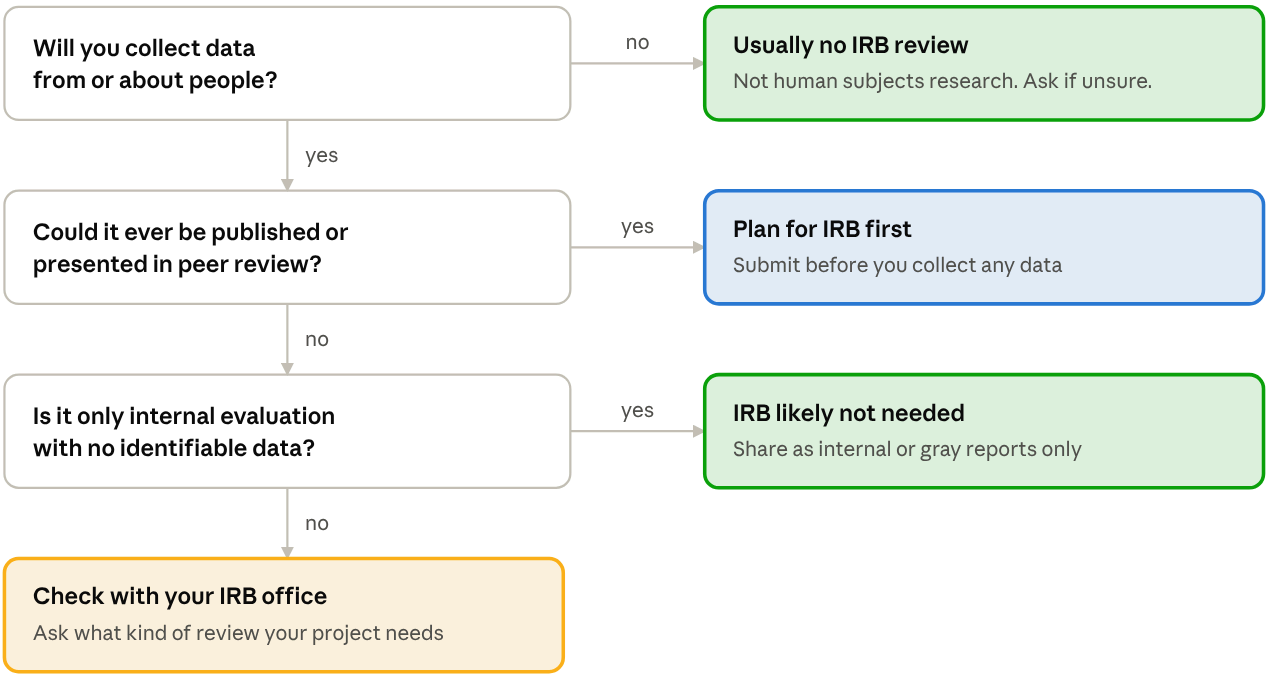
Before you collect data

Could it be peer reviewed?
Can anyone be identified?
Who owns the data?
Ask your IRB office

The five steps and a pre-collection check

Do I need IRB? If it could ever be peer reviewed, plan for it first

Answer before you collect any data. When in doubt, ask your IRB office.



Do I need IRB? Your IRB office makes the final decision.

Remember: If your work could ever be peer reviewed, plan for IRB before you collect any data.

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